

Pre-Launch AI Risk Checklist

Purpose: Make a practical ship/no-ship decision before you publish, sell, demo, advertise, onboard users, or deliver AI-assisted client work.

When To Use It

Use this at the end of launch prep, after you have completed at least a first pass through the project snapshot, claims checklist, data intake, red flag triage, vendor note, disclosure builder, customer FAQ, incident log, and change log.

Use it again before major feature changes, public relaunches, paid ads, marketplace launches, client workflow changes, or model/vendor changes that affect users.

What This Produces

You should finish with:

- a checklist of launch basics
- a list of blockers and fixes
- a final launch decision
- an owner and next review date

Check an item only if it is true enough to rely on. If a high-risk issue is unresolved, pause or narrow the launch until it is reviewed.

Launch Scope

Field	Answer
Project / offer	
Launch type	[Private beta / public launch / paid product / client workflow / ad campaign / marketplace listing / other]
Launch date or target	
Decision owner	
Review date	

Checklist

1. Project Basics

- ☐ Project name, owner, date, stage, and next review date are recorded.
- ☐ The AI feature or workflow is described in plain English.
- ☐ Intended users, customers, clients, or audience are identified.
- ☐ The paid offer, business use, or client use is described.
- ☐ Human review points are documented.

Notes:

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2. Claims

- ☐ Landing page, product page, marketplace, demo, email, social, ad, proposal, and sales claims have been checked where relevant.
- ☐ Accuracy, automation, earnings, professional-advice, safety, privacy, and compliance-related claims have been reviewed.
- ☐ Overstated claims have been rewritten or removed.
- ☐ Any claims needing evidence are supported, narrowed, or held back.
- ☐ Public copy matches what the AI actually does today.

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3. Data And Privacy

- ☐ User data entering the AI workflow is listed.
- ☐ Data pasted into prompts, uploaded as files, sent through APIs, or stored in logs is listed.
- ☐ Third-party AI vendors receiving data are listed.
- ☐ Data-use, retention, logging, and training settings are checked or marked for review.
- ☐ Sensitive, confidential, credential, payment, child-related, or contract-restricted data has been avoided, minimized, or reviewed.
- ☐ Users are told what they need to know about AI involvement and data use.
- ☐ Users are told what not to submit where relevant.

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4. Disclosures And Customer FAQ

- ☐ AI-use disclosure is drafted.
- ☐ Output limitation language is drafted.
- ☐ Human review language is accurate.
- ☐ Not-professional-advice language is included where needed.
- ☐ Report-a-problem path is included.
- ☐ Customer FAQ answers are drafted for AI use, data use, output review, limits, and problem reporting.
- ☐ Disclosure and FAQ match the actual product behavior.

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5. Red Flags And Scope

- ☐ Red Flag Use Case Triage has been completed.
- ☐ Health, mental health, legal, financial, credit, employment, housing, education, insurance, children, biometrics, identity, surveillance, synthetic media, sensitive data, scraping, and automated-decision categories were checked.
- ☐ Any Yes or Unsure category has a next step.
- ☐ High-risk issues were paused, narrowed, escalated, or documented.
- ☐ The product does not invite excluded uses in its copy, onboarding, prompts, or examples.

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6. Human Review And Output Limits

- ☐ A person reviews output before it is sent, published, or used where needed.
- ☐ If the user is responsible for review, the product says that plainly.
- ☐ The product does not imply the AI is always accurate, current, complete, appropriate, unbiased, or authoritative.
- ☐ Important limitations are visible before users rely on output.
- ☐ The workflow has a way to stop, edit, discard, or override AI output.

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7. Vendor / Model Dependency

- ☐ Vendor, model, API, tool, or local model is recorded.
- ☐ Prompt and instruction locations are recorded.
- ☐ Known limitations are listed.
- ☐ Fallback plan is documented.
- ☐ Pricing, availability, terms, or data-setting questions are marked before launch.

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8. Support, Incidents, And Changes

- ☐ Users, customers, or clients know how to report incorrect, harmful, confusing, or unexpected output.
- ☐ Incident / Complaint Mini-Log exists and has an owner.
- ☐ Escalation triggers are understood.
- ☐ AI Change Log exists.
- ☐ Launch baseline entry has been added.
- ☐ Model, prompt, vendor, data-use, claim, disclosure, and behavior changes will be recorded.

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9. Platform, Client, And Marketplace Rules

- ☐ Marketplace, Gumroad, Shopify, Etsy, app store, social, ad platform, or client rules were checked where relevant.
- ☐ Refund, update, and support expectations are clear.
- ☐ No prohibited content, fake reviews, misleading testimonials, unsupported endorsements, or hidden material AI use are included.
- ☐ Any AI-generated image, voice, likeness, brand, logo, or synthetic media was checked for consent, platform rules, and disclosure needs.

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Blockers And Fixes

Blocker or open issue	Why it matters	Required fix before launch?	Owner	Due date	Status
		[Yes / No / Unsure]			[Open / In progress / Done]
		[Yes / No / Unsure]			[Open / In progress / Done]
		[Yes / No / Unsure]			[Open / In progress / Done]

Final Launch Decision

Decision	Mark one	Use when	Notes
Ready to launch as scoped	☐	No material blockers remain and the record matches the actual workflow.	
Launch only after listed fixes	☐	Fixes are clear and limited.	
Narrow scope before launch	☐	The broad version is risky, unclear, or unsupported, but a narrower version may work.	
Private beta or limited test only	☐	More observation is needed before a public or paid launch.	
Pause and get qualified help	☐	A red-flag, legal, privacy, security, platform, client, or sector issue needs review.	
Do not launch in current form	☐	The current version is too unclear, unsupported, or risky to put in front of users.	

Decision owner: [NAME]

Decision date: [DATE]

Next review date: [DATE]

Review Carefully If

- Any checklist item is incomplete but the project is about to be public, paid, advertised, or client-facing.
- A red-flag category is marked Yes or Unsure.
- The product handles sensitive data or affects real-world decisions.
- Public copy promises more than the AI workflow can support.
- You are tempted to launch because the template is filled out even though the substance is still unresolved.

Short boundary: This worksheet is educational information, not legal advice. It helps you document a launch decision and spot questions to review. Review specific legal, privacy, contractual, security, platform, or regulatory obligations with qualified counsel or the appropriate advisor.